

Lágesvuon sáhku with Unjárga king (Vuonnamárgan style)

By Mikkel Berg-Nordlie (adjusted by Kajsa Møllersen). [More](#) about sáhku and other versions.

Even [more](#) (in Norwegian)

Before the game starts

The players throw dice. The first one to get X (*sáhku*) starts.

Dice

There are three dice, inscribed with X-III-II-blank. X signifies "move an activated piece 1 *sárggis*", "activate a piece", or "rethrow die". The latter means that when a player throws X, they are allowed to rethrow the X-giving die in the hope of getting another value, and may rethrow again until the die lands on another value than X.

It is not optional which die value is used first. One must first use the dice showing X, then use the ones showing III, and following this use the ones showing II. If you have a III that you can't use to perform a legal move, and a II that you could have performed a legal move with, then you can't use the II.

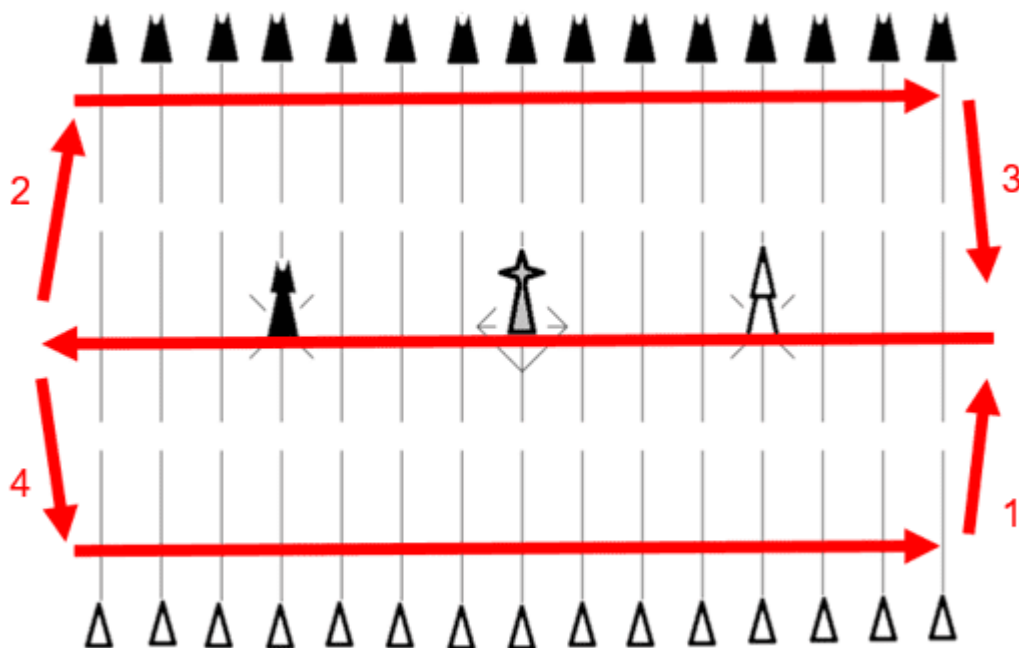
The soldiers' movement

Soldiers must be activated in order - rightmost soldier first. Unactivated soldiers can't be moved and can't be captured. It is never allowed to move a piece onto a *sárggis* occupied by an unactivated soldier.

The soldiers' "track" is that they move to the right on their home row, to the left on the middle row, and to the right on the enemy row.

If a soldier should survive the enemy row, it moves onto the middle row and walks towards the left again. When it reaches the middle row's end for the second time, it must move down instead of up. It goes back into the home row and repeats the movement pattern.

If you lose all your soldiers, you have lost the game.



The king's movement

The king moves orthogonally right, left, up, and down. It may move orthogonally up and down, by using exact die values: from the home row it needs II to cross directly over to the enemy row, and X to cross directly over to the middle row, while from the middle row it needs X to cross over to the home row or enemy row. Also, the king may move both forwards and backwards within the "8"-shaped movement pattern of the soldiers.

Recruiting the king

When the game begins, the king is neutral.

Unjárga king: The king is recruited the first time when a soldier enters the home row of the enemy. The king now belongs to that player.

After that, the king can be recruited back and forth: When you move a soldier or queen of yours onto a *sárggís* occupied by the king, you recruit it, and you may use it as your own piece. The king may never be captured, but can be recruited back by your opponent at any time.

The queen's movement

The queen moves just like the king. When the game begins, the queen is unactivated. This means that she can't be moved and can't be captured, and no piece may be placed on the *sárggís* where she stands. She may be activated by using a *sáhkku* (X). Her activation move may be up, down, left, or right - dependent on what moves are legal for her in the concrete situation. Unlike the king, the queen can be captured just like an ordinary soldier. If you lose your queen, you have lost the game.

Cohabitation

There may be several active soldiers on one *sárggis*, but all of them are captured if an enemy piece is moved onto the *sárggis* where they stand.

A royal piece may *not* share a *sárggis* with any other piece. The only exception to this rule is that you can move your soldier or queen onto a *sárggis* occupied by the enemy-controlled king, upon which you recruit the king. In no other circumstance is it legal to move another piece onto a *sárggis* occupied by a royal piece, or to move a royal piece onto a *sárggis* currently occupied by a piece that is part of its own army.

The rule stating that a royal piece cannot share a *sárggis* with another piece in its own army, and the above-mentioned rule stating that a *sárggis* where an unactivated piece stands may not be entered by any active piece, have the effect that royal pieces are not very mobile in the beginning of a *sáhkku* game, but as pieces are activated or captured, the royal pieces become increasingly free to move around on the board.